is just an example. When you get administrator access to the virtual machine, you have full control and are able to install the application and configure the operating system as needed.

You will learn how to connect to an EC2 instance by using the AWS Systems Manager Session Manager. The advantages of this approach follow:

- You do not need to configure key pairs upfront but use temporary key pairs instead.
- You don’t need to allow inbound SSH or RDP connectivity, which limits the attack surface.

Using AWS Systems Manager Session Manager comes with the following requirements:

- Works with virtual machines based on Amazon Linux 2, CentOS, Oracle Linux, Red Hat Enterprise Linux, SUSE Linux Enterprise Server, macOS, and Windows Server.
- Requires the SSM agent, which is preinstalled on Amazon Linux 2, macOS >10.14, SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 12/15, Ubuntu Server >16.04, and Windows Server 2008–2012/2016/2019/2022.
- Requires an IAM role that grants permissions to the AWS Systems Manager service; see the previous section.

The following instructions guide you through the steps necessary to connect to the EC2 instance you launched in the previous section, which fulfills all of the following requirements: